

HEADLINE JUDGMENT

Note: 31 Jul figures are intraday prints. A data flag first, and this time it is a resolution rather than an exception: the extract's 29 Jul row, which never refreshed for yesterday's edition, has now been fully backfilled with true closes, and MOVE, VIX, SOFR and JGLA have all printed for 29 and 30 Jul. Both 29 and 30 Jul are therefore confirmed closes and every trigger test below runs off them. **Score RISES to 26/30 — the US-inflation impulse fires 4→5 on two consecutive confirmed closes of 5Y5Y forward inflation above the 2.30% trigger (2.3302% on 29 Jul, 2.3303% on 30 Jul) — the first channel move in twelve sessions and the highest reading since 12 June.** This is the upgrade the monitor flagged yesterday as the nearest available move, and it fired exactly as the discipline requires: an intraday break on 30 Jul, then confirmation, and only then the point. Five of six channels are now at or above 4 and four are maxed at 5. The second consequential line also went through. **Stage-4 Threshold B — the 30Y above 5.20% with the 10Y above 4.65% — was satisfied on both legs on two consecutive confirmed closes (5.2007%/4.6773% on 29 Jul, 5.2135%/4.6733% on 30 Jul), the first time in the war.** The 30Y close of 5.2135% is the highest in the series and 16.35 bp above the 13 May auction stop. Persistence is now the test, and the very first print after the trigger is a shade softer: this morning the 30Y eases to 5.1965%, 0.35 bp back beneath its leg, while the 10Y at 4.6531% stays 0.31 bp above. The tape this morning is a partial give-back of the post-FOMC repricing rather than a reversal of it. Yields are lower across the curve (2Y −1.1 bp, 10Y −2.0 bp, 30Y −1.7 bp), 5Y5Y slips 0.74 bp but holds 2.29 bp above its trigger for a third session, and crude gives back \$0.92 to \$85.96 with the active COA at \$88.18. Two of yesterday's data gaps closed and both cut against the reassuring reading: MOVE resolved at 77.09 on the 30 Jul close, up 2.91 on the day and above the 75 line that forms the second leg of the Treasury downgrade, so that downgrade is doubly dead; and Asia LNG backfilled to a rising ¥3,527, not a stale ¥3,418. The events kept deteriorating and still cannot register: CENTCOM ran a second consecutive night over Iran, describing a heavy wave against dozens of IRGC targets; an Iranian strike killed a worker in Kuwait, the first fatality on Kuwaiti soil; Jordan intercepted five more missiles; and Gharibabadi hardened again, from 'the strait will remain closed' to **'the strait will never return to its pre-war state.'** Maritime and escalation have been pinned at 5/5 since 10 and 9 Jul, so none of it moves the number — the point that arrived today came from a US bond market repricing the Fed, not from Hormuz. That is the central fact of this edition and of the month now closing: July's damage was done to the long end. Sequencing 25 → 25 → 26.

1 · Live tape

Oil and natural gas — Bloomberg front-month / active

31 Jul 2026 readings are intraday prints. The 29 and 30 Jul rows have both refreshed and are confirmed closes; yesterday's stale-row exception is resolved. d/d is 31 Jul intraday vs the 30 Jul close; w/w is vs the 24 Jul close (five sheet-rows back); vs-pre-war is against the 27 Feb 2026 close. Restated continuation series (front-month CO2/CL2) in force. Today is the last trading day of July and the ICE Brent September contract expires, so the active COA rolls; the scored CO2 continuation series is unaffected.

Benchmark	Intraday 31 Jul	Δ d/d	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent front-month	\$85.96 /bbl (H 87.45 / L 85.70)	−\$0.92 (−\$5.72 w/w)	from \$72.48 (+18.6%) — a \$13.48/bbl premium; a third consecutive lower print, giving back the strike-resumption bid; active COA prints \$88.18	CO2 Comdty (Close)
Brent · 30 Jul close (last confirmed)	\$86.88 /bbl	−\$1.21 vs the 29 Jul close \$88.09	\$8.12 below the \$95 trigger on a close basis ; \$14.40 above the \$72.48 anchor. On the month, +19.1% from the 30 Jun close of \$72.92 — Bloomberg headlines July at roughly +21% on the active contract.	CO2 Comdty (Close)
WTI front-month	\$79.88 /bbl	−\$0.92 (−\$5.27 w/w)	from \$67.02 (+19.2%) — back under \$80; the CL2 artifact persists, active CLA prints \$82.37 against CL2's \$79.88	CL2 Comdty (Close)
Brent–WTI spread	\$6.08 /bbl	unchanged	\$5.81 on the active contracts (COA \$88.18 / CLA \$82.37)	derived
Henry Hub natural gas	\$2.758 /MMBtu	unchanged (−\$0.130 w/w)	from \$3.06 (−10.0%) — US gas still BELOW pre-war; the Hormuz/LNG-routing signature intact, this is not a global-energy shock	NGA Comdty (Close)
TTF Dutch gas (active)	€57.800 /MWh	−€0.517 (−€5.849 w/w)	from €31.23 (+85.1%) — €5.85 below the 24 Jul war record €63.65, but +34.2% on the month from €43.44	TZTA Comdty (Close)
Japan/Asia LNG (30 Jul close — no 31 Jul print)	¥3,527	+¥58 vs the 29 Jul ¥3,469	from ¥1,669 (+111.3%) — the two-session blackout has RESOLVED: 29 and 30 Jul both backfilled, and the series was rising, not stalling. No 31 Jul print; flagged, NOT carried forward	JGLA Comdty (Close)

US Treasuries and inflation expectations — Bloomberg

31 Jul 2026 yields are intraday. The 29 and 30 Jul closes are both confirmed and are the two readings on which the US-inflation upgrade and Stage-4 Threshold B are judged. d/d is vs the 30 Jul close; w/w vs 24 Jul. See section 2.1.

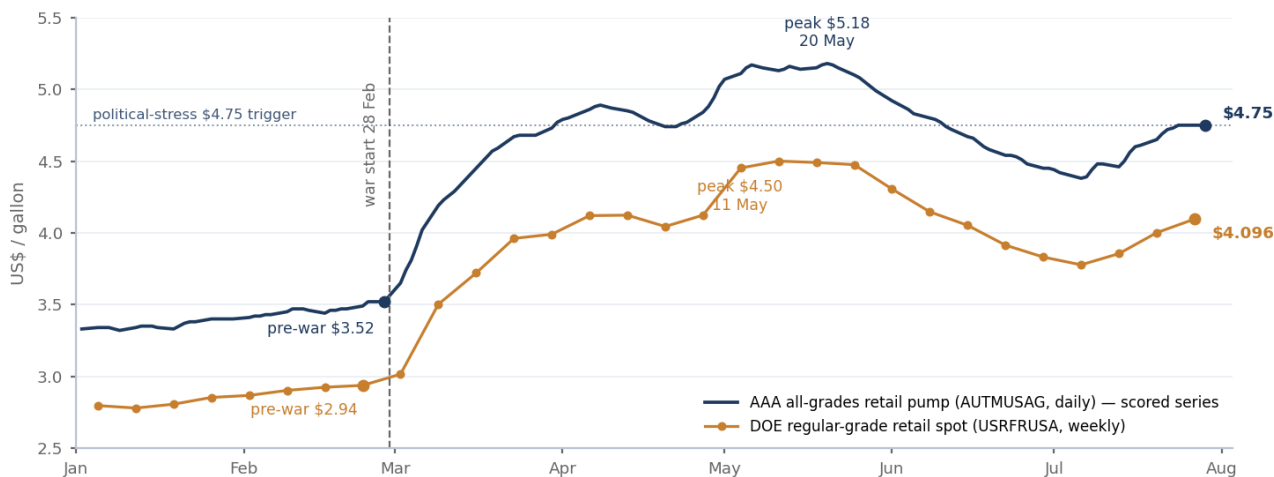
Tenor	Yield (%) — intraday 31 Jul	Δ d/d (bp)	Δ w/w (bp)	Δ vs pre-war (bp)	BBG ticker
2-year UST	4.24	−1.1	−9.5	+86.1 (from 3.37%) — the front end has led the whole week lower	USGG2YR Index
5-year UST	4.37	−1.6	−5.4	+87.0 (from 3.50%)	USGG5YR Index
10-year UST	4.65	−2.0	−2.4	+71.6 (from 3.94%) — 4.6531%, still 0.31 bp ABOVE the 4.65% Stage-4 leg after two confirmed closes above it	USGG10YR Index
30-year UST	5.20	−1.7	+3.9	+58.6 (from 4.61%) — the 30 Jul close of 5.2135% is the highest in the series and 16.35 bp above the 13 May auction stop; this morning 5.1965%, 0.35 bp back under the 5.20% Stage-4 leg and 19.65 bp above the 5.00% downgrade line	USGG30YR Index

Tenor	Yield (%) — intraday 31 Jul	Δ d/d (bp)	Δ w/w (bp)	Δ vs pre-war (bp)	BBG ticker
2s10s spread	+41.6 bp	−1.0	+7.3	−14.1 (still flatter than pre-war) — but +12.9 bp on the month and 17.3 bp off the 24 Jun war low of +24.25 bp	USYC2Y10 Index
10Y breakeven inflation	2.257	−0.4	+1.0	−0.03 (from 2.2569%) — back EXACTLY on its pre-war anchor, to three decimal places	USGGBE10 Index
5Y5Y forward inflation	2.323	−0.7	+3.5	+18.1 (from 2.14%) — confirmed closes of 2.3302% (29 Jul) and 2.3303% (30 Jul), both above the 2.30% trigger: the US-inflation channel FIRES 4→5. Still 2.29 bp above the line intraday	USG5Y5Y Index
SOFR (lagged, 29 Jul)	3.65	—	+1 bp	series lags; +1 bp since 24 Jul, unmoved by the FOMC hold	SOFRRATE Index

Cross-asset stress and political-transmission gauges — Bloomberg

Gauge	Latest	As of	Δ vs pre-war	Interpretation
DXY	100.16	31 Jul intraday	+2.56 (from 97.61)	UP 0.30 this morning after a 1.02 fall on the 30 Jul close to 99.86 — a much larger dollar decline than yesterday's AM snapshot showed. Down 1.31 on the week and 1.02 on the month. A softer dollar through a week of renewed strikes remains the clearest evidence that this is an inflation-credibility repricing, not a haven bid.
MOVE	77.09	30 Jul close	+3.71 (from 73.38)	Data gap RESOLVED. 74.18 on the 29 Jul FOMC close, then 77.09 on 30 Jul: rates vol fell on the day of the decision and rose after it, net +1.00 over the two sessions. At 77.09 it is ABOVE the 75 downgrade leg, so the Treasury downgrade fails on both legs, not just on the 30Y.
VIX	17.09	30 Jul close	−2.77 (from 19.86)	Also resolved: 20.66 on 29 Jul (+2.45, equities fell hard), then 17.09 on 30 Jul as the S&P rallied 1.3% and the Nasdaq 2.3%. Equity vol is back below pre-war while rates vol sits above it — the stress is in duration, not in equities.
AAA gasoline	\$4.75 /gal	29 Jul print (30–31 Jul pending)	+\$1.23 (from \$3.52, +34.9%)	Political-stress score reference. The 28 and 29 Jul prints backfilled at \$4.75 — a fourth consecutive session exactly ON the trigger without going through it — and 30–31 Jul are blank. AAA's separately published regular-grade average was \$4.098 on 30 Jul against \$4.091 a week earlier: +0.7¢ in a week. The run has stalled.
DOE gasoline	\$4.096 /gal	27 Jul weekly print	+\$1.16 (from ~\$2.94, +39.4%)	Corroboration only; the next weekly print is due 3 Aug. EIA has crude stocks 7% below the five-year average and gasoline stocks ~7% below, so there is still no domestic slack if crude runs.

US retail gasoline — the two tracked series, 2026 year-to-date



AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump, daily) is the political-stress score reference (pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest confirmed print \$4.75 on 29 Jul; 30 and 31 Jul blank); USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot, weekly) is the complementary gauge (pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest \$4.096 for the week of 27 Jul). The dotted line is the \$4.75 political→5 threshold. The scored series has now printed exactly \$4.75 on four sessions — 24, 27, 28 and 29 Jul — and has not gone through it. AAA's published regular-grade national average moved \$4.091 to \$4.098 across the week to 30 Jul, seven-tenths of a cent, which corroborates a stall rather than a break.

Strait operational state

Indicator	Current reading	Source
Strait closed · day ~154	Closed since 28 Feb; naval blockade plus escort operation unchanged. Traffic ticked up off the floor: Kpler counted 14 commodity vessels crossing in both directions on 29 Jul, up from single digits the previous week, and Windward logged 20 transits the same day (10 in / 10 out) of which four ran dark; the Gulf fleet is 812 vessels with 135 flagged high-risk. US Energy Secretary Chris Wright put roughly 6.5 mb/d of oil out of the Gulf via Hormuz over the past week. Against a pre-crisis baseline of 88–130 transits a day, that is still only about 11–15% of normal, and Kpler notes Gulf loading activity fell by more than half for the first time in six weeks. War-risk cover is 7.5–10% of hull value against 1–3% before the escalation, roughly \$2.5m per VLCC passage; the VLCC Jamaica Prosperity was fixed at WS 465 for a Gulf–China cargo, about \$500,000 a day.	Kpler / Windward / IMF PortWatch / Lloyd's List / Marsh via S&P Global / Bloomberg
A SECOND NIGHT — CENTCOM heavy wave over Iran, 29–30 Jul	CENTCOM said it struck 'dozens of IRGC targets in Iran, including military command centers, missile and drone facilities, coastal surveillance and defense sites, and maritime capabilities,' framed as a response to Iran's 28 Jul launches. A single retaliatory night has become a two-night sequence, which is the distinction between a cycle and a restarted campaign. Iranian state media reported a family of three killed by a strike on a home on Qeshm Island and further strikes on Ahvaz (Tier 3, casualty toll not independently verified). Cumulative US losses stand at 18 service members killed and more than 600 wounded.	CENTCOM 29 Jul / AP / Reuters / NYT / Al Jazeera / Middle East Eye / Press TV (Tier 3)
Iranian fire spreads — a first fatality in Kuwait	An Iranian strike hit a Chinese company's building in northern Kuwait, killing one worker: the first death on Kuwaiti soil in the war. Jordan's armed forces intercepted five more Iranian missiles with no casualties. The IRGC claimed an 'Operation Nasr 2' that destroyed drone hangars and a fuel depot at Ali Al Salem Air Base in Kuwait and three F-35s in Jordan; CENTCOM says all missiles were intercepted and the claims are uncorroborated (Tier 3).	Kuwait Defence Ministry via AP / Reuters / Arab News / Jordan (Petra) via AP / Press TV (Tier 3)
Mediation — Iran hardens again; Pakistan says talks continue	Gharibabadi moved from 'the strait will remain closed' to ' the strait will never return to its pre-war state, ' demanding total control of the northern route and calling the southern Omani corridor illegal and unsafe. The IMO confirmed it is not party to the Iran–Oman talks and that any new routeing scheme needs formal member-state submission, so neither the Omani nor the Iranian plan currently has standing. Oman's foreign minister convened Gulf counterparts on 29 Jul. The one positive thread: Pakistan's foreign ministry said on 31 Jul that negotiations are ongoing and that it is working to return both sides to the June 'Islamabad MoU.' The IRGC said two tankers attempted the southern lane on 28 Jul, one caught fire and both turned back (Tier 3, no vessel names, unverified).	The National / Al Jazeera / Pakistan Today / Express Tribune / IMO / Press TV (Tier 3)
Energy infrastructure and the Red Sea	Aramco has told Reuters via Industrial Info that the 400k b/d Jizan complex stays offline until mid-August after a Houthi strike damaged its IGCC powerplant and tank farm. Satellite imagery reportedly shows burn scars across four of the six spheroids at Abqaiq; Aramco has not commented, and no throughput loss is verifiable. Saudi crude has been pushed off Bab al-Mandeb almost entirely since the 20 Jul Houthi embargo, with Suez-routed volume up 106% to 1.06 mb/d and voyage times going from ~24 to ~54 days. Bab al-Mandeb ran 21 commodity transits on 29 Jul, down from 38 the day before. Saudi Arabia launched a 14-nation Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance on 30 Jul — note its remit is the Red Sea, Bab al-Mandeb and Gulf of Aden, NOT Hormuz. Attribution for the 29 Jul Damietta drone strike on the Gaslog Salem and the US-owned Energos Winter is still unresolved; the Houthis denied it and unnamed Iranian sources told the NYT it was designed to show what deeper disruption would look like.	Reuters / Industrial Info / Maritime Executive / The National / Kpler / Al Jazeera / NYT

2 · US economic shock — analysis with bond yields

The US economic shock rises to 26/30, its first move in twelve sessions and its highest reading since 12 June. The point did not come from Hormuz. It came from the US bond market, which spent the two sessions after the FOMC hold pricing a permanently higher inflation compensation into the long end, and it fired only once two confirmed closes were on the board. That sequencing matters: the monitor held this channel at 4 yesterday with the trigger 3.11 bp through on an intraday print, and took the point today when 29 and 30 Jul both closed above 2.30%. The same two closes satisfied Stage-4 Threshold B on both legs for the first time in the war. Meanwhile the geopolitical track got worse again — a second consecutive night of US strikes on Iran, a first fatality in Kuwait, five more missiles over Jordan, and Iran moving from 'the strait will remain closed' to 'the strait will never return to its pre-war state' — and none of it could move the number, because maritime and escalation have been maxed since 10 and 9 Jul. This morning's tape gives a little back: yields lower across the curve, crude down \$0.92, the 30Y 0.35 bp under its Stage-4 leg. That is a partial retracement of a large repricing, not a reversal, and it is exactly the kind of print the persistence test exists to absorb.

2.1 · Bond-yield transmission

31 Jul yields are intraday. Both the 29 and 30 Jul rows are confirmed closes — yesterday's stale-row exception has resolved — and all trigger tests run off them. One channel moved: US inflation 4→5. Score 25→26.

(i) US inflation impulse — UPGRADED 4→5. The trigger is confirmed. 5Y5Y forward inflation closed at 2.3302% on 29 Jul and 2.3303% on 30 Jul, two consecutive confirmed closes above the 2.30% upgrade line, with the 30 Jul close the highest reading in the series. That is the sustained break the trigger specifies, and it is the same standard that fired this channel 3→4 on 15 Jul on the second consecutive close above 2.20%. Yesterday the monitor held at 4 with the line 3.11 bp behind it on an intraday print and said one confirmed close would start the clock and a second would fire it; both arrived. This morning's 2.3229% is 2.29 bp above the trigger for a third session, so the upgrade is not resting on a single pair of closes. The corroboration is more mixed than it was: the 10Y breakeven has come back to 2.2566%, which is its 2.2569% pre-war anchor to three decimal places, after two sessions above. That divergence is itself informative — spot ten-year compensation is unchanged from before the war while the five-year forward five-year rate is 18.09 bp higher. The market is not pricing more inflation now; it is pricing a higher terminal inflation rate, which is precisely the kind of expectations damage a central bank cannot fix with a single hike. The mechanism remains the 29 Jul hold against three dissents for a tightening, from a Chair who has removed forward guidance and whose message is rhetorical rather than operational. Note also what did not do the work: June core PCE, released 30 Jul, was +0.1% m/m and +3.3% y/y, cooler than the 0.2% consensus on the month. Breakevens rose anyway. The downgrade (5Y5Y sustained at or below the 2.142% anchor) is 18.09 bp away and not in play. At 5/5 this channel is now maxed and can only subtract from here.

(ii) Treasury — held at 5; the downgrade now fails on both legs. The 30Y closed at 5.2135% on 30 Jul, the highest in the series, leaving 21.35 bp of cushion above the 5.00% downgrade leg; this morning's 5.1965% still leaves 19.65 bp. More important, the MOVE gap has closed and it closed the wrong way for the downgrade: 74.18 on the 29 Jul FOMC close, then 77.09 on 30 Jul, so rates vol is above the 75 leg, not below it. Yesterday the monitor recorded MOVE as unresolved rather than as reassurance and declined to claim it was 1.09 pts from release; that judgment holds up, though the intermediate detail is worth recording honestly — vol actually fell on decision day and only rose afterwards, so the inference that it 'has almost certainly risen' was right in net over two sessions but wrong about the FOMC session itself. The character of the move is unchanged and is the point: a bear steepener with breakevens up and the dollar down. Over July the 30Y is 26.2 bp higher, 2s10s is 12.9 bp steeper, and the dollar is 1.02 lower. This morning's small bull flattening — every tenor lower, the curve 1.0 bp flatter — is a month-end print, not a change of regime. September hike odds sit somewhere between 57% and 61% on the two independent CME FedWatch reads I can corroborate, up from 32–38% before the meeting; a 81% figure is circulating from a single non-financial outlet and is not used here.

(iii) Oil — held at 2, and the striking thing is again how little crude is doing. The last confirmed close is \$86.88 (30 Jul), \$8.12 below the \$95 upgrade trigger; this morning's \$85.96 is \$9.04 below it, a third consecutive lower print. Crude has now given back most of the strike-resumption bid even as the strikes ran a second night, Iran killed a worker in Kuwait and Tehran hardened its position on the strait to permanence. July was still a violent month for the barrel — +19.1% on the close basis, from \$72.92 on 30 Jun to \$86.88 — but the direction of travel in the last three sessions is down. The physical picture argues the other way: Jizan's 400k b/d refinery is out to mid-August, Abqaiq shows unexplained burn scars on four of six spheroids, Saudi crude has been forced off Bab al-Mandeb onto a 54-day Suez routing, and the IEA puts effective OPEC+ spare capacity at roughly 0.17 mb/d excluding shut-in Iranian and Russian barrels. Against that sit the offsets that have absorbed every escalation this month: OPEC+ is expected to approve a final +188k b/d for September at the 2 Aug meeting before pausing, and the IEA's members have released 290 mb since 11 March with over 1 bn bbl left. The US strategic cushion is the one that is visibly wearing out — the SPR fell another 3.7 mb to 307.7 mb in the week to 24 Jul, an eighteenth consecutive weekly draw and the lowest since 1983. The downgrade to 1 requires a mediated pause AND a close at or below \$72.48; with Iran now saying the strait will never return to its pre-war state, the pause condition is remote and the downgrade is effectively unavailable even though the price leg is \$13.48 away.

(iv) Political — held at 4; the stall at the line is now four prints long. AUTMUSAG printed exactly \$4.75 on 24, 27, 28 and 29 Jul and is blank for 30 and 31 Jul. The upgrade needs the series sustained ABOVE \$4.75, and sitting on the line is not through it. The external cross-read continues to argue that the stall is real: AAA's separately published regular-grade national average was \$4.098 on 30 Jul against \$4.091 a week earlier, a gain of seven-tenths of a cent across a week in which crude traded from \$82 to \$88 and back. RBOB has come off its 23 Jul two-month high. The pass-through pipeline is still tight — crude stocks about 7% below the five-year average, gasoline stocks about 7% below, refinery utilisation last confirmed at 96.2% for the week to 17 Jul, the SPR at 307.7 mb — so a sustained crude leg higher would still reach the pump quickly. But it has not happened, and on the evidence the channel is more likely to be taken off its trigger by a sub-\$4.75 backfill than through it. No federal intervention — SPR release, export limit, waiver or gouging action — is confirmable in the 29–31 Jul window.

2.2 · What would push the shock to Stage 4

Stage 4 is a credit/auction event. Threshold B, armed on an intraday print yesterday, is SATISFIED on confirmed closes today — the first time in the war. The persistence test now runs.

Threshold A · 13 May 30Y auction, cleared 5.050%. Historical benchmark; the 9 Jul re-opening cleared 5.06% with a 0.3 bp stop-through. The 30 Jul close of 5.2135% is 16.35 bp above the May stop, the widest margin of the war. The supply test is now dated: Treasury publishes its quarterly marketable borrowing estimates on Monday 3 August and the refunding statement on Wednesday 5 August at 8:30am ET, with the 30Y refunding leg auctioning in the week of 10 August. The May refunding held sizes at 3Y \$58bn / 10Y \$42bn / 30Y \$25bn and guided to

unchanged coupons 'for at least the next several quarters,' with dealers not expecting increases until early 2027. Any deviation from that guidance next week meets a long end that has just repriced 26 bp in a month.

Threshold B · 30Y above 5.20% with 10Y above 4.65% — SATISFIED on two consecutive confirmed closes. 29 Jul: 30Y 5.2007%, 10Y 4.6773%. 30 Jul: 30Y 5.2135%, 10Y 4.6733%. Both legs, both sessions. This is the first time in the war the threshold has been met on a close basis, and it is the single most consequential development in this edition after the score change itself. Two qualifications belong with it. First, the threshold is a warning that the long end is repricing in a way that historically precedes an auction or credit event; it is not itself a Stage-4 event, and Stage 4 requires the repricing to persist and then to show up in a failed or heavily tailed auction. Second, persistence is already being tested: this morning's 30Y at 5.1965% is 0.35 bp back beneath its leg, while the 10Y at 4.6531% holds 0.31 bp above. A close back under 5.20% tonight would leave B satisfied on two closes but not sustained — which is the same asymmetry the monitor applies to score channels, and the reason this is reported as a threshold met rather than a stage entered. The mechanism arming it is domestic monetary credibility, not a Hormuz headline.

Threshold C · MOVE above 130. Now evaluated, and far off. The series resolved after two blank sessions: 74.18 on 29 Jul, 77.09 on 30 Jul. At 77.09 the index is 52.91 pts below the threshold and well under the 115.02 war high of 26 March. Recorded as far off — but note it is 3.71 above its pre-war level and above the 75 line that forms the second leg of the Treasury downgrade, so the same number that makes C remote also makes that downgrade unavailable.

2.3 · Cross-asset

The cross-asset signature is now unambiguous and it is domestic. Over the two sessions since the FOMC the long end repriced hard and the dollar fell: the 30Y closed at a series high 5.2135%, 2s10s steepened to +42.53 bp, 5Y5Y set a series high at 2.3303%, and DXY dropped 1.02 to 99.864 on 30 Jul, a much larger fall than yesterday's morning snapshot showed. Rates vol rose to 77.09 while equity vol collapsed to 17.09 as the S&P added 1.3% and the Nasdaq 2.3% — a split that says the stress is in duration, not in risk assets. This morning partially unwinds it: yields 1–2 bp lower across the curve, the dollar 0.30 higher, crude 0.92 lower, TTF 0.52 lower. The energy complex has been fading all week — Brent down three sessions running, TTF €5.85 off its war record, WTI back under \$80 — while the rates complex did the damage. The one energy series still climbing is Asia LNG, which backfilled to ¥3,527 on 30 Jul, up ¥58 on the day and up ¥109 from the 28 Jul print that yesterday's edition had to leave hanging. Henry Hub at \$2.758 remains 10.0% BELOW pre-war: the routing signature is intact and this is still not a global-energy shock. The month-end frame is the cleanest summary of July: Brent +19.1%, TTF +34.2%, the 30Y +26.2 bp, 2s10s +12.9 bp steeper, 5Y5Y +15.1 bp, and the dollar down 1.02. The war moved energy; the Fed moved the curve; and it is the curve that added the point today.

3 · Shock score

Total: 26/30 — CRISIS band. Band thresholds: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · 22–30 crisis.

Channel	Score	Rationale	Triggers
Maritime denial	5/5	Held at 5 (max). Strait closed to commercial traffic, day ~154. Traffic has ticked off the floor — Kpler 14 commodity transits on 29 Jul against single digits the prior week, Windward 20 transits of which four dark — but that is still roughly 11–15% of the 88–130/day pre-crisis baseline, and Gulf loading activity fell by more than half. Iran hardened from 'the strait will remain closed' to 'the strait will never return to its pre-war state,' and the IMO confirmed it is not party to the Oman talks, so no reopening framework has standing.	↑ at max. ↓ verified reopening (escorted convoys) with traffic above 25% of normal for 10 sessions → to 3–4.
Oil price shock	2/5	Held at 2. Last confirmed close \$86.88 (30 Jul), \$8.12 below the \$95 trigger; intraday \$85.96, \$9.04 below it, active COA \$88.18. A third consecutive lower print through a second night of US strikes on Iran, a first fatality in Kuwait and Iran declaring the closure permanent. July was +19.1% on the close basis, but the last three sessions have gone the other way: OPEC+ supply, over 1 bn bbl of IEA stock capacity and an eighteenth straight SPR draw are absorbing the risk premium.	↑ Brent above \$95 sustained → to 3. ↓ mediated pause + close at/below the \$72.48 anchor → to 1 (the pause condition is remote after Iran's 'never return to its pre-war state').
US inflation impulse	5/5	UPGRADED 4→5 (max). 5Y5Y forward inflation closed at 2.3302% on 29 Jul and 2.3303% on 30 Jul — two consecutive confirmed closes above the 2.30% trigger, the second of them the highest reading in the series — and prints 2.3229% intraday today, a third session above the line. Same standard that fired 3→4 on 15 Jul. The 10Y breakeven has fallen back to 2.2566%, exactly its pre-war anchor: spot compensation is unchanged from before the war while the forward is 18.1 bp higher, which is terminal-rate damage rather than a near-term energy pass-through.	↑ at max. ↓ 5Y5Y sustained at/below the 2.142% pre-war anchor → to 4 (18.1 bp away).
Treasury stress	5/5	Held at 5 (max). The 30Y closed at 5.2135% on 30 Jul, the highest in the series, 21.35 bp above the 5.00% downgrade leg; 5.1965% intraday leaves 19.65 bp. The MOVE gap resolved at 74.18 (29 Jul) then 77.09 (30 Jul), ABOVE the 75 leg, so the downgrade now fails on both legs rather than one. Over July the 30Y is +26.2 bp and 2s10s +12.9 bp steeper with the dollar down — the signature of inflation-premium rebuilding, not haven demand.	↑ at max. ↓ 30Y close under 5.00% with MOVE under 75 sustained → to 4.
Political stress	4/5	Held at 4. AUTMUSAG printed exactly \$4.75 on 24, 27, 28 and 29 Jul — four sessions ON the trigger without going through it — and is blank for 30 and 31 Jul, flagged and not carried. AAA's published regular-grade average went \$4.091 to \$4.098 across the week to 30 Jul, seven-tenths of a cent, and RBOB is off its 23 Jul high. With crude and gasoline stocks each ~7% below the five-year average and the SPR at 307.7 mb there is no slack if crude runs, but it has not run.	↑ gasoline above \$4.75 sustained → to 5. ↓ toward the \$3.52 pre-war level → to 3.
Escalation risk	5/5	Held at 5 (max) on a day that would otherwise have forced another upgrade. CENTCOM ran a second consecutive night over Iran against 'dozens of IRGC targets'; an Iranian strike killed a worker in Kuwait, the first fatality on Kuwaiti soil; Jordan intercepted five more missiles; Kataib Hezbollah has given Baghdad until 6 August over the US–Saudi strikes; and Iran declared the strait will never return to its pre-war state. The channel cannot register any of it.	↑ at max. ↓ mediated stand-down + talks resume → to 4–3.
TOTAL	26/30	CRISIS band — UP one point, the first channel move in twelve sessions and the highest reading since 12 June. The point came from the US bond market, not from Hormuz: two confirmed closes of 5Y5Y above 2.30% took the US-inflation impulse to its maximum. Four of six channels are now at 5/5. With maritime, escalation, US-inflation and Treasury all maxed, only oil (2/5) and political (4/5) retain any upside — the scale now has just four points left in it.	

4 · What's changed since the last edition (30 Jul → 31 Jul AM)

Score rises to 26/30. US inflation 4→5 on two confirmed closes. Stage-4 Threshold B satisfied on closes for the first time in the war. Yesterday's stale-row exception resolved. Source: Bloomberg unless stated.

The US-inflation impulse fires 4→5 and the score goes to 26/30. 5Y5Y forward inflation closed 2.3302% on 29 Jul and 2.3303% on 30 Jul, two consecutive confirmed closes above the 2.30% upgrade trigger, and prints 2.3229% intraday today. That is the sustained break the trigger specifies and the same standard applied on 15 Jul. It is the first channel move in twelve sessions and takes the score to its highest since 12 June. Four of the six channels are now maxed at 5/5. Source: Bloomberg.

Stage-4 Threshold B is satisfied on confirmed closes for the first time in the war. 29 Jul: 30Y 5.2007% with 10Y 4.6773%. 30 Jul: 30Y 5.2135% with 10Y 4.6733%. Both legs on both closes. The 30 Jul 30Y is the highest reading in the series and 16.35 bp above the 13 May auction stop. Persistence is the open question, and this morning the 30Y is 0.35 bp back under its leg at 5.1965% while the 10Y holds above at 4.6531%. Source: Bloomberg.

The extract's 29 Jul row has been backfilled, and MOVE, VIX, SOFR and JGLA have all resolved. Yesterday's data-integrity exception is closed. The 29 Jul row now carries true closes (Brent \$88.09 against the stale \$82.08; 30Y 5.2007%; 5Y5Y 2.3302%), and the blank series printed: MOVE 74.18 then 77.09, VIX 20.66 then 17.09, SOFR 3.65, JGLA ¥3,469 then ¥3,527. Both the 29 and 30 Jul rows are now confirmed closes and every trigger test in this edition runs off them. Source: Bloomberg extract.

Reconciliation: yesterday's Singapore-morning snapshot ran ahead of the close on crude and behind it on the long end. My 30 Jul intraday Brent of \$87.72 was \$0.84 above the \$86.88 close; WTI \$81.67 against \$80.80. The 30Y closed 0.75 bp HIGHER than my print at 5.2135%, the 2Y 2.47 bp lower at 4.2459%, 2s10s 1.86 bp steeper at +42.53 bp, and the dollar a full 1.005 lower at 99.864. 5Y5Y closed at

2.3303% against my 2.3311% print — a 0.08 bp difference, which is why the upgrade confirmed. Source: Bloomberg.

A second consecutive night of US strikes on Iran — a cycle becomes a campaign. CENTCOM said it struck ‘dozens of IRGC targets in Iran, including military command centers, missile and drone facilities, coastal surveillance and defense sites, and maritime capabilities.’ Iranian state media reported a family of three killed on Qeshm Island and further strikes on Ahvaz (Tier 3, unverified). An Iranian strike killed a worker in Kuwait, the first death on Kuwaiti soil in the war, and Jordan intercepted five more missiles. Source: CENTCOM / AP / Reuters / Al Jazeera / Kuwait Defence Ministry.

Iran hardened from a closed strait to a permanently changed one. Gharibabadi on 30 Jul: ‘The strait will never return to its pre-war state.’ Iran demands total control of the northern route and calls the southern Omani corridor illegal and unsafe. The IMO confirmed it is not party to the Iran–Oman talks and that any new routing scheme requires formal member-state submission, so neither plan has standing. The counterweight: Pakistan’s foreign ministry said on 31 Jul that negotiations are ongoing and that it is working to return both sides to the June ‘Islamabad MoU.’ Source: The National / Pakistan Today / Express Tribune / IMO.

June core PCE came in cooler than expected and breakevens rose anyway. Released 30 Jul: headline –0.1% m/m and +3.7% y/y, core +0.1% m/m against a +0.2% consensus and +3.3% y/y. A cool core print did not stop the forward inflation measure closing at a series high the same day, which is the clearest evidence that this is a credibility repricing rather than a data-driven one. July CPI on 12 August is the next real test before the 15–16 September FOMC. Source: BEA via Fox Business / LSEG consensus.

Saudi Arabia launched a 14-nation maritime alliance — for the Red Sea, not Hormuz. Announced 30 Jul with headquarters in Saudi Arabia and an EU delegation attending; members include Türkiye, Kuwait, Bahrain, Qatar, Jordan, Egypt, Pakistan and Djibouti. Its remit is Bab al-Mandeb, the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden. It does not address the Strait of Hormuz and does nothing for the maritime-denial channel. A separate report describes a 43-nation proposal; 14 is the confirmed number. Source: Saudi Ministry of Defence via Al Jazeera / MarineLink / The National.

5 · Scenario map · next 7 to 30 days

Scenario	P	Description	Market path
Return to full war	41%	Higher again and the strongest reading of the war. What was a single retaliatory night is now a two-night sequence of CENTCOM strikes on Iranian territory; Iranian fire has reached Kuwait fatally and Jordan again; and Kataib Hezbollah has set a 6 August deadline for Baghdad over the US–Saudi strikes, which is the clearest dated escalation risk on the calendar.	Brent \$105–140; MOVE above 90; oil to 3–4, political to 5; score 28–30.
Deal collapse — talks stall on terms	24%	Unchanged. Iran moved from rejecting Oman’s plan to declaring the strait permanently altered, and the IMO has confirmed no routing scheme has legal standing. Pakistan’s claim that negotiations continue is the only thread and it is unconfirmed by either principal.	Brent \$92–108; oil to 3; 30Y sustained above 5.20% with the 10Y above 4.65%, i.e. Stage-4 B persisting; score 27–28.
Contained but violent — blockaded stalemate	13%	Lower again. This path needed the resumption to be one retaliatory cycle. It ran a second night, spread to Kuwait and drew a 14-nation regional naval response. It survives only if strikes stop inside the next 48 hours.	Brent \$82–92; MOVE 72–82; risk premium \$10–20/bbl; score holds 26.
Regional relapse — Gulf energy infrastructure hit	15%	Higher. Jizan is confirmed out to mid-August, Abqaiq shows burn scars on four of six spheroids with no Aramco comment, Saudi crude is off Bab al-Mandeb entirely and routing 54 days via Suez, and Damietta showed reach onto the Mediterranean. Effective OPEC+ spare capacity is ~0.17 mb/d. A landed hit on the Saudi export corridor reprices everything.	Brent \$150+; emergency policy response; HY spreads above 500 bp; score 29–30.
Mediated pause — the ceasefire sticks	7%	Lower. Iran has moved from a tactical closure to a declared permanent change in the strait’s status, which is a harder position to walk back than a rejected fee schedule. Pakistan’s Islamabad MoU channel is the only live mechanism and neither principal has confirmed engagement.	Brent \$74–85; MOVE under 72; US-inflation→4, escalation→4; score falls toward 20–22.

Probability shifts from the 30 Jul edition: full war +3 (38→41), a new high for the map, on the second night of strikes, the first fatality in Kuwait and Kataib Hezbollah’s 6 August deadline; regional relapse +1 (14→15) on Jizan’s confirmed mid-August outage and the Abqaiq imagery; contained-but-violent –3 (16→13) because its precondition, a single retaliatory cycle, has failed; mediated pause –1 (8→7) on Iran’s move to a permanent framing, partly offset by Pakistan’s statement that talks continue; deal collapse unchanged at 24. Probabilities sum to 100.

6 · Watchlist · next 24 to 72 hours

Does Threshold B persist? The 30Y close is the number to watch. B is satisfied on the 29 and 30 Jul closes but this morning’s 5.1965% is 0.35 bp back under the 5.20% leg. A close above 5.20% tonight makes it three of three and turns a threshold met into a threshold sustained; a close below leaves it met but not persisting. Either way the real test is dated: Treasury’s borrowing estimates on 3 August, the refunding statement on 5 August, and the 30Y refunding leg in the week of 10 August.

Whether 5Y5Y holds above 2.30% now that the channel has fired. The upgrade is confirmed and the channel is maxed, so the risk from here is one-directional. Today’s 2.3229% is the third consecutive session above the line. A sustained retreat toward the 2.142% anchor — 18.1 bp away — would be the first downgrade candidate the monitor has had in the market channels since the oil move of 3 July.

The 2 August OPEC+ meeting, and whether oil’s refusal to price the escalation survives it. A final +188k b/d for September then a pause is the expected decision. Brent has fallen three sessions running through a second night of US strikes on Iran; either the market is discounting the campaign, or OPEC+ barrels and the 290 mb of IEA releases are absorbing more risk premium than the physical picture justifies. Effective spare capacity of ~0.17 mb/d says the second reading is fragile.

6 August — Kataib Hezbollah's deadline to the Iraqi government. The clearest dated escalation risk on the calendar. KH called retaliation for the US–Saudi strikes 'inevitable,' threatened US assets in Saudi Arabia specifically, and gave Baghdad until 6 August to demonstrate it can defend national sovereignty. Iraq's PM has already cancelled his first official visit to Riyadh in protest.

AUTMUSAG's backfill — a print below \$4.75 takes political off its trigger. The scored series has printed exactly \$4.75 on four sessions and is blank for 30 and 31 Jul. AAA's published regular-grade average moved seven-tenths of a cent across the week to 30 Jul. A sub-\$4.75 backfill would be the first move off the trigger since 24 July and would make a political downgrade, not an upgrade, the live question.

Asia LNG and the Mediterranean vector. JGLA resolved higher, ¥3,469 then ¥3,527, and is the one energy series still climbing while Brent and TTF fade. Verify the next print fresh; it is never carried. Attribution for the Damietta strike on the Gaslog Salem and the US-owned Energos Winter remains unresolved, with the Houthis denying it and unnamed Iranian sources telling the NYT it was a demonstration of capability.

7 · Source log · this edition

Tier 1 — primary market data. Bloomberg Terminal extract (US Iran BBG Data.xlsx, 154 rows × 99 columns, restated front-month continuation series). Tickers: CO2/CL2 Comdty (front-month; last confirmed close \$86.88 / \$80.80 on 30 Jul, intraday \$85.96 / \$79.88); COA/CLA Comdty (active, unscored — \$88.18 / \$82.37, with the ICE Brent September contract expiring today); NGA (\$2.758, unchanged), TZTA (€57.800) and JGLA (¥3,527 on the 30 Jul close, backfilled after a two-session blackout; no 31 Jul print, flagged not carried); USGG2YR/5YR/10YR/20YR/30YR (30Y closed 5.2135% on 30 Jul, the highest in the series; 5.1965% intraday); USYC2Y10 (+41.568); USGGBE10 (2.2566 — back exactly on the pre-war anchor); USGG5Y5Y (confirmed closes 2.3302% on 29 Jul and 2.3303% on 30 Jul, both above the 2.30% trigger; 2.3229% intraday); SOFRRATE (lagged, 29 Jul, 3.65%); MOVE (74.18 on 29 Jul, 77.09 on 30 Jul — the blackout resolved) and VIX (20.66 then 17.09); DXY (99.864 on the 30 Jul close, 100.163 intraday); AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades pump — score reference; \$4.75 on 24, 27, 28 and 29 Jul, 30–31 Jul blank) and USRFRUSA (DOE regular spot, weekly — corroboration; \$4.096 for the week of 27 Jul). **Data-integrity note:** yesterday's exception is closed. The 29 Jul row, which had failed to refresh, now carries true closes and differs materially from the stale values (Brent \$88.09 vs \$82.08; MOVE 74.18 vs blank), so both 29 and 30 Jul are confirmed closes and the d/d series through this window is sound. The 27 Feb 2026 anchor was re-verified field by field and is unchanged.

Tier 1 — news and institutional. US CENTCOM (the 29 Jul release on the second-night strikes against 'dozens of IRGC targets in Iran, including military command centers, missile and drone facilities, coastal surveillance and defense sites, and maritime capabilities') via AP, Reuters, NYT, WSJ and Al Jazeera; Kuwait's Defence Ministry (one worker killed at a Chinese company's building in northern Kuwait) via AP, Reuters, Arab News and Al Arabiya; Jordan's armed forces via Petra and AP (five Iranian missiles intercepted, no casualties); The National and Al Jazeera (Gharibabadi's 30 Jul 'the strait will never return to its pre-war state,' the Iranian and Omani routing proposals, and the IMO's confirmation that it is not party to the talks); Pakistan Today and Express Tribune (the foreign ministry's 31 Jul statement that negotiations continue under the June Islamabad MoU); Kpler and Windward (Hormuz transit counts for 29 Jul, Gulf loading activity, Bab al-Mandeb 21 transits) with Marsh via S&P Global Commodity Insights (war-risk cover at 7.5–10% of hull value) and Lloyd's List Intelligence; US Department of Energy (Secretary Wright's ~6.5 mb/d Hormuz figure) via Bloomberg; Reuters citing Industrial Info and Saudi Aramco (Jizan offline to mid-August) and Maritime Executive (Abqaiq spheroid imagery, the Damietta strike on Gaslog Salem and Energos Winter); The National (Saudi crude off Bab al-Mandeb, Suez volumes +106% to 1.06 mb/d); Saudi Ministry of Defence via Al Jazeera and MarineLink (the 14-nation Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, Red Sea remit); Bureau of Economic Analysis via Fox Business (June PCE: headline -0.1% m/m, +3.7% y/y; core +0.1% m/m, +3.3% y/y); Federal Reserve (the 29 Jul FOMC statement and Chair Warsh's press conference) with CME FedWatch (September hike odds 57–61%); US Treasury (quarterly refunding calendar — borrowing estimates 3 August, refunding statement 5 August; May sizes 3Y \$58bn / 10Y \$42bn / 30Y \$25bn) and the 29 Jul sanctions action on Iran's Hormuz 'extortion network'; EIA Weekly Petroleum Status Report (crude and gasoline stocks ~7% below the five-year average; SPR 307.7 mb, an eighteenth consecutive draw); IEA Oil Market Report of 10 July (effective OPEC+ spare capacity ~0.17 mb/d; 290 mb released since 11 March, over 1 bn bbl remaining); Bloomberg and OilPrice (the 2 August OPEC+ meeting, a final ~188k b/d for September then a pause); AAA published pump averages for 29–30 July; Roll Call, the Washington Post and CBS News (the 49–50 Senate vote blocking the Gillibrand war-powers resolution on 30 July); AP-NORC (64% of Americans say the war has not been worth fighting, fielded 23–27 July, n=1,165, ±3.7pp).

Tier 3 — state media and combatant claims (labelled). IRNA, Press TV and Tasnim report a family of three killed by a US strike on a home in the Chah-Tango neighbourhood of Qeshm Island and further strikes on Ahvaz; Middle East Eye and Al Jazeera carried the account but no Tier 1 outlet has independently verified the toll and no US comment on civilian casualties could be found. The IRGC's 'Operation Nasr 2' claim to have destroyed drone hangars and a fuel depot at Ali Al Salem Air Base in Kuwait and three F-35s at a Jordanian base is uncorroborated and is directly contradicted by CENTCOM, which says all missiles were intercepted; it is recorded and not used. The IRGC statement that the strait 'is not reopenable as long as the excessive rhetoric and threats by US officials continue' was carried by AFP and is treated as a reliable report of a statement, not of a fact. The IRGC account of two tankers attempting the southern lane on 28 Jul, one catching fire and both turning back, names no vessels and is unconfirmed by any operator, US official or third-party tracker; it moves nothing. Speaker Qalibaf's 'the US will pay the price' is a statement of position. Houthi denial of responsibility for the Damietta strike is a combatant claim, as is the unattributed briefing by unnamed Iranian sources to the NYT that the attack was a demonstration of capability; attribution remains unresolved and is reported as such.

8 · On-demand update protocol

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh the Bloomberg extract	Parse the latest dated row (31 Jul) as intraday; re-map columns via the robust scan (front-month CO2/CL2). The integrity check that flagged a stale 29 Jul row yesterday now clears: the row has been backfilled with true closes and differs materially from the stale values, so 29 and 30 Jul are both confirmed closes. JGLA checked fresh — blackout resolved, ¥3,469 then ¥3,527, no 31 Jul print, flagged not carried. MOVE and VIX resolved (74.18/77.09 and 20.66/17.09). AUTMUSAG backfilled to \$4.75 for 28 and 29 Jul, blank 30–31 Jul, flagged not carried. SOFR lagged, 29 Jul.
2	Recompute deltas	d/d vs the 30 Jul close; w/w vs the close five trading sessions back (24 Jul this edition); vs-pre-war against the 27 Feb 2026 anchor, re-verified field by field and unchanged. Month-end comparisons run against the 30 Jun close.
3	Re-evaluate the six channels	Market channels move on confirmed closes only. US inflation UPGRADED 4→5 on two consecutive confirmed closes of 5Y5Y above 2.30% (2.3302% and 2.3303%). Oil held at 2 (last close \$86.88, \$8.12 below \$95). Treasury held at 5 (30Y 5.2135% close, MOVE 77.09 — both downgrade legs fail). Political held at 4 (AAA \$4.75, four prints ON the line, two blank). Maritime and escalation are event-based and both maxed, so the second night of strikes, the Kuwait fatality and Iran's permanent-closure framing register in the narrative but not the score.
4	Reconcile against the prior edition	Full reconciliation restored. My 30 Jul intraday Brent \$87.72 versus the \$86.88 close (−\$0.84); WTI \$81.67 vs \$80.80; 30Y 5.2060% vs 5.2135% (+0.75 bp); 2Y 4.2706% vs 4.2459% (−2.47 bp); 2s10s +40.67 vs +42.53 bp; 5Y5Y 2.3311% vs 2.3303% (−0.08 bp, which is why the upgrade confirmed); DXY 100.869 vs 99.864 (−1.005). The 29 Jul stale row is superseded by true closes.
5	Update scenarios and watchlist	Re-rank catalysts: Threshold B persistence and the 3–5 August refunding calendar replace the US-inflation upgrade as the nearest live development; the 2 August OPEC+ meeting tests oil's refusal to price the escalation; 6 August is Kataib Hezbollah's deadline to Baghdad; AUTMUSAG's backfill decides whether political moves off its trigger. Full war 38→41, regional relapse 14→15, contained-but-violent 16→13, mediated pause 8→7, deal collapse unchanged at 24.

9 · Methodology

Shock-score scale. Six transmission channels (maritime denial, oil, US inflation impulse, Treasury stress, political stress, escalation risk), each 0–5, summed to 0–30. Bands: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · 22–30 crisis. Market channels move only on a confirmed close through a trigger; escalation-risk and maritime denial are event-based. Hysteresis: upgrades fire on a sustained break, downgrades only on a sustained reversal past a wider threshold, deliberately, to avoid whipsawing. This edition is the payoff to that discipline rather than a cost of it. Yesterday 5Y5Y was 3.11 bp through its upgrade trigger on an intraday print and the channel held at 4; today two consecutive confirmed closes above 2.30% take it to 5 and the score to 26. The same rule held this channel at 3 on 14 July against a 2.2061% close with a 0.6 bp margin before firing on the second close on 15 July, and spared the oil channel a whipsaw through both the \$95 approach of 23 July and the \$12.18 unwind that followed. Stage-4 Threshold B is evaluated identically, which is why two confirmed closes on both legs are reported here as the threshold being satisfied while a single intraday print yesterday was reported only as arming it.

Scale cap — still the governing constraint. Maritime and escalation have been pinned at 5/5 since 10 and 9 July, and US inflation and Treasury are now maxed as well. Four of six channels are at their ceiling. On 31 July CENTCOM ran a second consecutive night over Iranian territory, an Iranian strike killed a worker in Kuwait, Jordan intercepted five more missiles, and Tehran declared the strait permanently altered — and not one of those inputs could raise the score. Only oil (2/5) and political stress (4/5) retain upside, which leaves four points of range in a 30-point scale. Readers should treat a flat or slow-moving number from here as evidence that the scale is running out of room, not as evidence that conditions are stable.

Data integrity this edition. Yesterday's exception is resolved: the extract's 29 July row, which had failed to refresh and was therefore treated as a stale snapshot, now carries true closes that differ materially from the stale values (Brent \$88.09 against \$82.08, 30Y 5.2007%, 5Y5Y 2.3302%, MOVE 74.18). Both 29 and 30 July are confirmed closes and the d/d series through this window is sound. MOVE, VIX, SOFR and JGLA have all printed for both sessions, closing four blackouts at once. Per the discipline established after the JGLA stale-carry episode, a missing print is flagged and never carried forward as if fresh: JGLA (no 31 July print) and AUTMUSAG (blank 30–31 July) are flagged accordingly. Where third-party sources disagree materially — Brent's 30 July settle, September hike odds, Hormuz transit counts as a share of normal — the disagreement is reported rather than resolved by preference, and the Bloomberg extract governs for every scored series.

Gasoline series. Political stress is scored on AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump; pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest confirmed print \$4.75 on 29 July, with 24, 27, 28 and 29 July all printing exactly \$4.75 and 30–31 July blank). USFRUSA (DOE regular spot; pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest \$4.096 for the week of 27 July) is tracked alongside as corroboration only. Neither series is re-based. AAA's separately published regular-grade national average (\$4.091 a week earlier, \$4.098 on 30 July) is used only as an external cross-read on whether the stall in the scored series is real; it is not substituted for it.

Pre-war anchor (27 Feb 2026 close). Brent \$72.48; WTI \$67.02; 2Y 3.375%; 5Y 3.502%; 10Y 3.938%; 30Y 4.611%; 2s10s +55.64 bp; 5Y5Y 2.142%; 10Y BE 2.257%; MOVE 73.38; VIX 19.86; DXY 97.608; gasoline (AAA) \$3.52; Henry Hub \$3.06; TTF €31.23; Asia LNG ¥1,669. (Re-verified field by field — unchanged.) Brent +18.6%, WTI +19.2%, TTF +85.1%, Asia LNG +111.3%; the 30Y (+58.6 bp), 10Y (+71.6 bp), 5Y5Y (+18.1 bp), MOVE (+3.71) and DXY (+2.56) sit above their anchors; the 10Y breakeven is back exactly on its anchor (−0.03 bp); VIX (−2.77) and Henry Hub (−10.0%) remain below pre-war.

Intraday caveat. The latest dated row is a Singapore-AM snapshot and US hours set the close. Yesterday's snapshot ran \$0.84 above the eventual Brent close and 0.75 bp below the eventual 30Y close, which is the usual pattern: the energy print leads, the long end lags. Recent Brent gaps between my snapshot and the subsequent close: +\$1.91, +\$0.60, +\$3.10, −\$1.81, −\$2.01, −\$3.32, −\$0.84. CL2 remains an artifact against active CLA, and today the ICE Brent September contract expires, so the active COA rolls while the scored CO2 continuation series does not. Triggers are evaluated on confirmed closes; escalation-risk and maritime denial are event-based. Restated-series levels are not comparable with pre-restatement editions, though the directional analysis is continuous.